Ryan M. Rickgauer

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Power Line Systems / Bentley Systems *November 2025 – Present*

Software Engineer

- Develop and maintain PLS-CADD, a large-scale C++ Windows desktop application used for overhead power transmission line design and analysis.
- Extend reporting capabilities by developing customizable reports, adding engineering data, and improving report generation and export functionality.
- Develop and enhance engineering tools involving structural optimization, cable stringing, and automated structure configurations.
- Own the full development lifecycle of new features, from investigating requirements and designing solutions to implementation, testing, and debugging.
- Design and implement new functionality for structure customization, project automation, and component library management.
- Diagnose and resolve complex issues involving data persistence, file management, engineering calculations, and graphical rendering within an established C++ and MFC codebase.

Definian *June 2020 – November 2025*

Software Engineer I → II → III

- Developed and maintained a data migration application used to transfer and transform data between legacy and modern systems.
- Built a C++ communication service to enable two-way communication between C# applications and native COBOL systems.
- Improved application performance and maintainability through multithreading, dependency injection, and domain-driven design.
- Helped modernize the application by migrating its frontend from VB6 to WPF and rewriting legacy Intel Assembly code in C++.
- Implemented a personalized form validation service within WPF applications, speeding up development and setting a strong base for future projects.

EDUCATION AND HONORS

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science (May 2020)

Northern Illinois University, DeKalb, IL

SKILLS

Languages: C++, C#, Python, SQL, COBOL, HTML/CSS, TypeScript, SASS.

Frameworks/Libraries: .NET, C++/CLI, STL, Boost, Flask, Win32, DevExpress, WPF, WinUI.

Tools/Technologies: Git, Jira, GitHub, Visual Studio, Teams Foundation Server, Confluence.